

The 6:15

WEDNESDAY · SEPTEMBER 2, 2026

NO. 9

THE BOARD

CALENDAR (NEXT 10 DAYS)

Wed 9/2	Broadcom (AVGO) reports after close, ~5p ET call — cons. rev. \$29.43B (+84% Y/Y), non-GAAP EPS ~\$3.22-3.24, AI-semis guide \$16B (+200%+ Y/Y)
Thu 9/3	Initial jobless claims, wk. ended 8/29, 8:30a (last: 203K, wk. ended 8/22)
Fri 9/4	Aug. jobs report (NFP), 8:30a (BLS) [consensus not verified this run] — July's -23K miss (cons. +83K) is the bar
Sat 9/5	Northwestern opens vs. South Dakota State, 7p CT
Sun 9/6	OPEC+ virtual meeting; group expected to hold quotas after completing its 3.5 MMbpd cut rollback in Aug.
Mon 9/7	Labor Day — markets closed
Tue 9/8	Canada's dollar-for-dollar tariffs on ~\$27.6B of U.S. imports take effect
Fri 9/11	Aug. CPI, 8:30a (BLS)
Tue-Wed 9/15-16	FOMC — decision/SEP Wed 2p, presser 2:30p. Hike odds 66.1% (CME FedWatch, Mon close) vs. 57-59% Fri

[DEVELOPING] Anthropic's public S-1 still unfiled (confidential draft since 6/1); roadshow expected Sept.-early Oct., targeting an Oct. Nasdaq listing, >\$60B raise **[timeline reported, not confirmed]**. [NEW] Anthropic signed a \$35B Nvidia-backed Lambda compute deal (8/31, Texas) — its second mega compute deal in a week after \$45B with Nscale (WV).

METRICS · AS OF ~6:15A ET / 1013Z UNLESS NOTED

Oil	Brent \$94.9-95.1 (sources disagree) ; WTI overnight futures +4.5% near \$90, no clean settle [unverified]
Rates	2Y 4.40%, 10Y 4.79-4.80% (highest since Jan. '25), 30Y 5.28% (Treasury.gov, Mon close)
FX/Vol	DXY ~99.4-99.5 (Mon close); VIX closed >16 Tue (16.80 intraday high) vs. Mon's sub-15 close, lowest monthly close since Nov. '24

Futures	S&P E-mini -0.08%, Nasdaq 100 E-mini -0.28%, Dow E-mini +0.01% (premarket Wed)
Equities (Tue close)	S&P 7,631.47 (-0.71%), Dow 52,766.88 (-0.79%), Nasdaq 26,099.77 (-1.03%)
Asia	Nikkei 64,495 (Wed close, -2.60%); Hang Seng last verified 25,567 (Mon close) [Wed close unverified]
Gold / Gas	Gold prints disagree, \$4,300-4,600 range this run ; retail gas \$4.0954/gal natl. avg (AAA, 9/1)

Crude: ICE Brent front-month / NYMEX WTI front-month, no clean settle located either grade this run. Rates: Treasury.gov par curve. Equities: exchange closes via CNBC/Bloomberg quote pages.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Closure	Day 185 (straits.live, 9/2 1013Z)
Transits	PortWatch (8/23): 3/day vs. 85/day baseline = 4%. Kpler: 121 crossings 17-23 Aug (vs. 118 prior wk); 5 vessels 8/25 vs. 10-day avg 15 [no fresher Kpler figure this run]
Strikes (24h)	CENTCOM struck ~100 Iranian targets 9/1; 2 Iranian govt. tankers hit under new "tanker for tanker" policy — first of its kind. Running total not refreshed this run [stale]
Congestion	450 vessels holding off berth, 7-day range 249-997 (straits.live). Dark-tanker AIS-gap % not located fresh this run [stale]
War-risk premium	~\$10.0M/VLCC transit, ~40x pre-crisis (straits.live) — unchanged

Kpler's near-real-time AIS daily counts, Lloyd's List's slower weekly aggregation, and PortWatch's baseline-comparison snapshots measure different things over different windows — never netted or averaged against each other.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Beat Angels 7-3 (9/1). 78-60, 2nd AL East, 5.0 GB Tampa Bay (83-55), holds AL's No. 1 Wild Card.
Knicks	Finalizing Josh Hart extension: 4-yr/\$81M through 2027-28. [NEW]
Northwestern	Off-season. Opens Sat 9/5 vs. South Dakota State, 7p CT.

US strikes ~100 Iranian targets under new "tanker for tanker" policy; oil to six-week highs, 10-year to its highest since January 2025, complicating an already-hawkish Fed path

The uneasy calm that held for most of August broke decisively this week. Late Monday into Tuesday, unidentified projectiles struck two commercial tankers — the Sidr and the Senegal Prosperity — inside the southern corridor the U.S. Navy patrols as the strait's designated safe passage, while Iran separately attempted to lay mines in the waterway and struck at a U.S. military base in Jordan, per Trump's account on Truth Social. [NEW] CENTCOM said it responded Tuesday by striking roughly 100 Iranian targets — air-defense sites, radar systems, maritime assets and facilities, mine-laying capabilities, communications infrastructure, anti-ship cruise-missile launchers and drone launchers. For the first time in the conflict, the U.S. also struck two Iranian government tankers directly, hitting their engine rooms with drone-launched missiles while the vessels sat anchored off Iran's coast north of the U.S. blockade line — the debut use of a new "tanker for tanker" deterrence policy Trump approved in recent days specifically to raise the cost of further Iranian attacks on Gulf shipping. [NEW]

Iran's retaliation was largely intercepted: roughly 25 ballistic missiles were fired, with only about half reaching Jordanian airspace; drones aimed at Bahrain and Kuwait were mostly shot down, as were two drones targeting the Erbil base in Iraq. [fact] Iranian state media claimed a U.S. strike hit a wedding in Kuhestak, killing at least four and wounding 35; a CENTCOM spokesman disputed the

claim, saying the U.S. military "never targets civilians." [flag: single-sourced to Iranian state media, disputed by CENTCOM, not independently confirmed] A U.S. official told Axios the strikes degraded Iran's attack capability in the strait and should buy "at least a month" of lower threat levels for commercial shipping — though Trump has also threatened a "significantly larger response" should Iran retaliate further, and the IRGC has vowed its "offensive operation will continue... until they regret their crime." [read: neither side has signaled this is the last exchange, and the tanker-for-tanker policy raises the ceiling on future retaliation cycles rather than lowering it — Tuesday reads as an escalation with a built-in expiration date, not a resolution.]

Mechanism: Brent jumped roughly 5% intraday Tuesday to near \$95/bbl, its highest since late July, and was still trading around \$94.9-95.1 Wednesday morning (Trading Economics, [straits.live](https://www.tradingeconomics.com/straits/live), as of 6:15a ET) **[sources disagree to the decimal]**; WTI futures rose as much as 4.5% overnight toward \$90, though no clean settlement was located this run. **[unverified]** That supply-side price shock landed directly on a bond market already repricing for a more hawkish Fed after Chair Warsh's Friday Jackson Hole keynote — the 10-year Treasury yield climbed to 4.79-4.80% Tuesday, its highest since January 2025, and CME FedWatch put September hike odds at 66.1% by Monday's close, up from 57-59% at the end of last week. [fact] The S&P 500 fell 0.71% to 7,631.47 Tuesday, the Nasdaq dropped 1.03% to 26,099.77, and the VIX closed above 16 for the first time in weeks — a sharp reversal from Monday's sub-15 close, itself the lowest monthly VIX close since November 2024. [fact]

The second-order consequence is a genuinely uncomfortable one for the Fed: an oil-driven inflation shock is arriving exactly as Warsh

has committed to treating "underlying inflation" as the binding constraint on policy, two weeks before the September 16 decision and with the August CPI print (September 11) now carrying an energy-price tailwind that wasn't in the data when Warsh spoke Friday. [read: a hawkish Fed chair who wants to hike into resilient growth now also has a live geopolitical justification for treating any near-term inflation uptick as durable rather than transitory — that raises the odds Warsh doesn't walk back Friday's framing even if next week's jobs report comes in soft, since a supply shock argues for looking through weak labor data the way a demand shock would not.] Equity futures were only modestly lower Wednesday morning (S&P E-minis -0.08%, Nasdaq 100 E-minis -0.28%, Dow E-minis flat) — a muted reaction relative to Tuesday's move, suggesting markets are treating this as a continuation of an existing risk rather than a fresh regime change, for now. [read] There's a third variable layering on top of the Fed and oil: Broadcom reports fiscal Q3 results Wednesday evening, hours after this latest exchange, against a Street looking for \$29.43 billion in revenue and roughly \$16 billion of AI-semiconductor sales — a print that will land into a tape already digesting a geopolitical oil shock rather than the calm backdrop Nvidia and Marvell got in late August. [read: a Broadcom beat this week would have to work harder to move the market than Marvell's did on Aug. 27, since risk appetite has to clear the oil-and-rates hurdle first; a miss would compound Tuesday's selloff rather than stand on its own.] Energy Secretary Wright's disclosure that 17 million barrels transited the strait Monday — the highest single-day volume logged since the conflict began — sits awkwardly next to the sub-5%-of-baseline throughput figures on the Board, a discrepancy this issue flags rather than resolves (see Iran & Hormuz).

POLITICS

Congress passed a stopgap funding bill Tuesday, clearing the House 370-48 after Senate passage in early August, and sent it to Trump's desk — funding the government at current levels through December 11 and averting a shutdown ahead of the September 30 fiscal-year deadline. [NEW] The bill also blocks OMB's proposed rule subjecting federal grants to political-appointee review and bars the administration from redirecting other program funds to Border Patrol. [fact] The bipartisan 370-48 margin — after three partial shutdowns totaling 161 days since Trump's second term began — reflects election-season urgency to avoid a fourth. [read] Separately, the Lisa Cook Fed-removal fight hasn't moved: no White House response to her attorney's late-August letter has surfaced, and the underlying case remains queued for Supreme Court argument in January. [continuity: unchanged since 8/27]

Massachusetts' Democratic Senate primary wrapped Monday: 80-year-old incumbent Ed Markey defeated 47-year-old Rep. Seth Moulton roughly 65%-35%, leaning on endorsements from Sanders and Warren and his Green New Deal record to beat back a generational-change challenge; he faces Republican John Deaton in November. [NEW] The margin was more comfortable than pre-primary Democratic anxiety about the party's aging leadership had suggested. [read] The primary calendar's final stop is Colorado's 8th District Democratic primary, selecting an opponent for GOP freshman Gabe Evans, later this month. [fact]

ECONOMICS

July's jobs report, released Aug. 7, is the weak comp Friday's August number needs to beat: nonfarm payrolls fell 23,000 against a Dow

Jones consensus for +83,000, the unemployment rate ticked down to 4.1% from 4.2%, and the composition was worse than the headline — private payrolls rose just 30,000 while government payrolls fell 53,000, with softness concentrated in retail, leisure/hospitality and slower healthcare hiring. [fact] The more current read doesn't show the same deterioration: initial claims for the week ended Aug. 22 came in at 203,000, down 4,000 from the prior week — a labor market still showing no cracks at the weekly-claims level even as the monthly payroll print turned negative. [fact] The week-ended-8/29 claims print, the last before Friday's jobs report, is due Thursday morning. [read: the gap between soft monthly payrolls and steady weekly claims is exactly the kind of ambiguous signal Warsh's framework can read either way — it lets him credit "full employment" from the claims data while discounting the payrolls miss as noise. Friday's report either resolves that ambiguity or deepens it two weeks before the FOMC decision, and now does so against an oil price that's moved materially since July.]

BUSINESS

Apple's 15-year Tim Cook era as CEO ended Tuesday: John Ternus, the company's hardware-engineering chief and a 25-year Apple veteran, became CEO effective September 1, with Cook moving to executive chairman. [NEW] The transition — flagged in an April announcement and executed on schedule — hands an engineer rather than an operations specialist the job of answering Apple's persistent AI-strategy weakness relative to Google, Microsoft and OpenAI. [read] Salesforce and Anthropic's expanded "Claudeforce" partnership, announced Aug. 26 alongside Salesforce's Q2 beat, ships as a 37-skill plugin letting Claude act directly inside Salesforce data and workflows; Salesforce shares rose 12% after-hours the day both

landed together — a reaction as much about the earnings beat as the AI framing. [fact] Broadcom reports fiscal Q3 after Wednesday's close, guided against a \$29.43 billion consensus (+84% Y/Y) and non-GAAP EPS near \$3.22-3.24, with AI-semiconductor revenue expected near \$16 billion (+200%+ Y/Y) — the next data point in the AI-capex broadening thread that ran through Nvidia's and Marvell's late-August beats, now landing hours after an oil shock rather than alongside a calm tape. [NEW] The FTC and 22 state attorneys general sued Amazon in Seattle federal court Monday, alleging the company secretly inflated auction prices across its Sponsored Products, Sponsored Brands and Sponsored Display ad formats, overcharging roughly 1.2 million advertisers — including more than 500,000 small and mid-size businesses — by more than \$20 billion since 2019. [NEW] Amazon hasn't yet filed a public response; the case adds a second live antitrust front against the company alongside its existing FTC marketplace suit. [fact]

TECHNOLOGY

Anthropic signed a \$35 billion cloud-compute deal with Nvidia-backed Lambda on Aug. 31 for roughly 350 megawatts of capacity at a Hut 8-developed site in Nueces County, Texas — Nvidia's role spans chip supplier, Lambda equity backer and site lease anchor in the same transaction. [NEW] It's Anthropic's second mega compute deal in a week, following a \$45 billion Nscale agreement for West Virginia capacity — a pace of AI-infrastructure commitment that continues even as the company's own IPO paperwork (see Board) remains unfiled. [read: the compute spending is running well ahead of the public disclosure investors will eventually need to evaluate it against.] Nvidia's role as both chip supplier and equity backer of the intermediate cloud provider in the same \$35 billion transaction has

drawn scrutiny as a potential circular-financing structure — Nvidia effectively financing demand for its own chips through an entity it also partly owns — though none of the parties has characterized it that way publicly. [read] No verified frontier-model release, rocket launch, or other VC round beyond what's logged here fell inside this run's window.

GEOPOLITICS

Russia bombarded Kyiv for a sixth straight night into Sept. 1, killing seven — six of them railway workers — in a ballistic-missile strike on a rail depot; broader strikes hit targets across nine additional Ukrainian regions using Iskander-M/KN-23, Tsirkon, Kalibr and Kh-31P missiles plus more than 200 drones. [NEW] Ukraine struck back at the Russian Baltic port of Ust-Luga in Leningrad Oblast with drones the same night. [fact] European officials are scrambling for more air-defense stock for Kyiv as the intensity of Russian infrastructure strikes continues to escalate rather than plateau — a pattern distinct from, but concurrent with, the Hormuz escalation dominating today's Lead. [read] Zelensky has continued pressing Washington and Europe to accelerate Patriot deliveries and grant licenses to build the systems domestically and in Europe, arguing allied warehouses hold interceptors that aren't reaching the front fast enough; Germany and Norway have separately committed to funding three additional Patriot batteries. [continuity: pressure campaign ongoing, no new commitment confirmed this run] Xi's Sept. 24 Washington summit remains on the calendar; no new movement on export controls surfaced this run.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond Tuesday's strikes (see Lead), the maritime picture: the Metro Venetian attack (Aug. 23-24, unattributed) remains unresolved — JMIC's most recent advisory (Aug. 25) describes a pattern of IRGC "attacks, attempted attacks, and harassment" without naming a specific actor for that incident, and no fresher UKMTO update was located this run. [continuity] The detained tanker Amara (Liberia-

flagged, seized near Qeshm Island Aug. 17 for allegedly bypassing Iran's mandatory transit-corridor and fee regime) remains held; no status update past Aug. 21 was found this run. **[stale]** Transit data is still split by vendor and wasn't refreshed past the Board's figures this run — PortWatch's snapshot (Aug. 23, 4% of baseline) and Kpler's weekly count (121 crossings 17-23 Aug) measure different populations over different windows and shouldn't be netted, per the standing methodology note. Energy Secretary Wright reported 17 million barrels transited the strait Monday — the highest single-day volume since the conflict began — a figure seemingly at odds with the sub-5% throughput reading above unless it reflects a wider stretch of "the strait" than the traffic-separation choke point straits.live/PortWatch track; that discrepancy wasn't reconciled this run. **[apparent inconsistency, not reconciled]** One plausible read: Wright's figure may count cumulative flow through the wider Gulf approach rather than the narrower traffic-separation choke point the trackers monitor, or may reflect a single unusually large convoy rather than routine throughput — neither is confirmed, and the two data sets simply haven't been reconciled by either side publicly. [read]

SPORTS

Yankees	Beat Angels 7-3 (9/1). 78-60, 2nd AL East (5.0 GB Tampa Bay), holds AL's No. 1 Wild Card.
Knicks	Off-season. Hart extension (4-yr/\$81M) finalizing — see Transactions.
Northwestern	Off-season. Opens Sat 9/5 vs. South Dakota State, 7p CT.

Continuity. Dropped or condensed as unchanged since 8/29: separate Economics section (folded into Lead — nothing distinct beyond the Fed/yields/CPI mechanism already covered there); Cook Fed case (no movement); Metro Venetian attribution (unchanged); Amara status (unchanged, stale past 8/21). For next issue: watch whether the "tanker for tanker" policy draws further Iranian

retaliation; watch Friday's jobs report and Sept. 11 CPI against the now oil-driven inflation backdrop; watch for Anthropic's public S-1; watch the Wright 17M-barrel figure against PortWatch/Kpler throughput data for a reconciliation.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.